

Διονύσιος ὁ Ἀλικαρνασσεύς

## Dionysius of Halicarnassus on the Ancient Orators

eul\_aid: ndy

**Period:** Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

**Dialect:** Ἀττική [Attic](#)

**Domain:** Ἱστορία [History](#)

**Format:** Λόγος [Oration](#)

Dionysius of Halicarnassus was a Greek historian, rhetorician, and literary critic who lived and worked in Rome during the late 1st century BCE. He arrived around 30 BCE and spent over two decades there, teaching rhetoric and researching Roman history. His position allowed him to act as a cultural intermediary, interpreting Roman history for a Greek audience while teaching Greek rhetorical arts to the Roman elite.

His most significant work is the *Roman Antiquities*, a 20-book history of Rome from its origins to 264 BCE, of which roughly half survives. His critical treatises, including *On the Ancient Orators*, *On Thucydides*, and *On the Arrangement of Words*, exemplify his commitment to Attic style and provide foundational analysis of classical oratory and historiography.

Dionysius is a crucial primary source for early Roman history, offering a detailed, pro-Roman narrative aimed at reconciling Greek audiences to Roman rule. As a leading proponent of Atticism, his literary criticism established influential principles of rhetorical theory and style.

### Works (18)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ῥώμης Χρονολογικά · [Chronological Fragments on Rome](#) · 11 passages
- Ἰσαῖος Ἀθηναῖος · [Isaeus the Athenian](#) · 23 passages
- Ἰσοκράτης Ἀθηναῖος · [Isocrates the Athenian](#) · 27 passages
- Ἐπιστολή πρὸς Ἀμμαῖον · [Letter to Ammaeus](#) · 16 passages
- Ἐπιστολή πρὸς Πομπήιον · [Letter to Pompeius](#) · 62 passages
- Λυσίας συρακούσιος πατρόθεν · [Lysias the Syracusan by Descent](#) · 38 passages
- Περὶ Δεινάρχου · [On Deinarchus](#) · 18 passages
- Περὶ Μιμήσεως · [On Imitation](#) · 26 passages
- Περὶ τῶν ἀρχαίων ῥητόρων · [On the Ancient Orators](#) · 5 passages
- Περὶ συνθέσεως ὀνομάτων · [On the Composition of Names](#) · 67 passages
- Περὶ Συνθέσεως Λέξεων · [On the Composition of Words](#) · 39 passages
- Περὶ τῶν Θουκυδίδου ἰδιωμάτων πρὸς Ἀμμαῖον · [On the Idioms of Thucydides to Ammonius](#) · 18 passages
- Περὶ τῆς Δημοσθένους λέξεως · [On the Style of Demosthenes](#) · 81 passages
- Περὶ Θουκυδίδου · [On Thucydides](#) · 68 passages
- Λείψανα Βιβλίου Δευτέρου περὶ ἀρχαίων ῥητόρων · [Remains of the Second Book-Ancient Orators](#) · 5 passages
- Ῥητορική Τέχνη · [Rhetorical Art](#) · 121 passages

- [Ῥωμαϊκὴ Ἀρχαιολογία · Roman Antiquities](#) · 952 passages
- [Μαρτυρία · Testimony](#) · 1 passages